

Medical discoveries

Your body is a fantastic, complex, living machine and, for thousands of years, people have been making groundbreaking discoveries that have enabled us to understand how it is assembled. Even today, scientists continue with their medical research, hoping to complete the missing pieces of our knowledge.

▼ **c. 1750 BCE** Babylonian king Hammurabi produces a set of written laws, some of which regulate the work of doctors, including cutting the arms off surgeons who make mistakes during surgery.



c. 350 BCE Greek philosopher Aristotle states that the heart is the origin of feeling and intelligence.



▲ **1000** Arab doctor Ibn Sina (also known as Avicenna) publishes important medical information, which influences medicine for the next 500 years.

▼ **1545** Ambroise Paré, a French surgeon, publishes *Method of Treating Wounds*, in which he describes his less painful, more successful techniques for treating wounds, such as using egg yolk and rose petals on injuries rather than boiling oil.



1800 BCE — 800 CE — 1400 — 1600



▲ **c. 420 BCE** Greek doctor Hippocrates is one of the first people to realize that diseases have natural causes and cures.



▼ **c. 130–210 CE** Roman-Greek doctor Claudius Galen describes how the body works. Although many of his ideas are wrong, they remain unchallenged for nearly 1,500 years.

890–932 Persian doctor Abu Bakr ar-Razi produces a number of important medical publications, and accurately describes measles and smallpox.



▲ **Late 1400s to early 1500s** From his own dissections, Italian artist Leonardo da Vinci produces accurate anatomical drawings of the human body.

1628 English doctor William Harvey publishes *On the Movement of the Heart and Blood*, describing how blood circulates around the body pumped by the heart.

▼ **1543** Flemish doctor Andreas Vesalius publishes *On the Structure of the Human Body*, the first accurate description of the human body, including the brain.

